

Main

Report Name (Org_Country_Year_Report Type)

ALA_South Africa_2024-25_3-month Report

Fellowship Organization

African Leadership Academy (ALA)

Fellowship City

Johannesburg

Fellowship Country

South Africa

Fellowship Start Date

08/01/2024

Anticipated Fellowship End Date

07/31/2025

What is your fellowship title/role?

Strategic Projects Associate

What are your primary responsibilities?

Strategic Research:

- o Support execution of the 2026 Very Young Entrepreneur Scenario (VYE) project, designing multi-year strategies and delivering annual outputs.

- o Identify Academic and other research partners for collaboration purposes.

- o Codify a body of evidence of impactful interventions in Very Young Entrepreneurship by Anzisha.

- o Produce VYE Scenario 2026 Green Papers for Investors and Education, Parents communities.

- Partnerships:

- o Work with the Chief of Staff on multiple projects with partner organizations in the African Entrepreneurial Education ecosystem.

- Monitoring and Evaluation:

- o Work with the Institutional Learning team to improve Monitoring and Evaluation processes and systems.

- o Support qualitative and quantitative research initiatives to capture Anzisha Fellows Venture Metrics and Learning Outcomes.

- Event Planning & Management:

- o Collaborate with various teams to coordinate and execute events that celebrate the achievements of young entrepreneurs.

- Programs Application and Selection Process:

- o Use Anzisha processes, tools, and systems to capture, share and present information on campaigns, applicants and finalists during the application and selection process.

- Weekly reports on application and selection season (campaigns and related activities)

- o Collaborate with the Analyst team through data-driven insights in selection season.

- o Compile and supply data for sponsor reporting as requested.

- Other Responsibilities:

- o Participate in various "all hands-on deck" activities on the Anzisha Program calendar as they arise, such as event logistics, workshops, and events.

- o Participate in African Leadership Academy Two-Year Program activities and engage students to the degree you are able and by agreement with your direct manager.

I receive adequate direction and support to perform my fellowship responsibilities.

Strongly Agree

Did you receive any sort of orientation, handover or onboarding when you started your fellowship?

Yes

Please describe your orientation/onboarding and note who handled it.

I went through an onboarding with ALA's HR department and learned the systems, then my manager did an onboarding for Anzisha.

If you did not receive any kind of orientation, what information or guidance were you provided at the start of your fellowship?**Describe a representative day at work.**

I usually come to campus at 9:30am and do desk work, attend meetings, and socialize.

On average, how many hours per week do you work?

How would you describe your effectiveness in your fellowship post so far?

Very Effective

Please briefly describe 1-2 specific projects that you have undertaken or accomplishments you have made so far.

1. The State of the VYE Scenario Research Project: I am planning and leading a research project and campaign for Anzisha to analyze interventions for youth entrepreneurship and engage stakeholders.
2. I have engaged different parts of the Anzisha team to align the goals of this research.

What is your organization's work culture like?**What is your office environment like? Please comment on the size and structure of the office(s) where you do most of your work.**

I work at a large shared desk with my team, with meetings held in breakout rooms.

To whom do you report?

Chief of Staff, they manage my work, and we work together on projects.

Have you had an initial check-in with your supervisor to set up a work plan and to set goals for your work during your fellowship year?

Yes

Was this meeting helpful in understanding your role and setting goals for your fellowship year?

Yes, we also established my key objectives and key results

Please explain why you have not met with your supervisor and if you have plans to do so going forward.**Please briefly indicate 3-5 professional goals you have for the rest of your fellowship year. Your professional goals should align with your work plan.**

1. Develop my project management skills
2. Network across the African entrepreneurial ecosystem
3. Learn more about communities of impact

How often do you check in with your supervisor?

Weekly

Have you had an opportunity to travel for work so far?

Yes

Describe this travel opportunity. Include location(s) and a brief description of the purpose of the trip(s).

Canberra, Australia. Chaperoning a student attending a symposium.

I feel adequately prepared for my position's professional responsibilities.

Agree

Please briefly explain your response.

I feel prepared, but I think I need to grow my project management skills.

Life at Fellowship Site

How did you travel to your host country and site? Please be specific

ALA purchased a one way ticket for me from Raleigh to Newark to Johannesburg. I don't have a return ticket yet.

What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

Visitor - Volunteer Visa

How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

Through an application to South African Consulate.

Did you apply for and receive your visa / permit before heading to your host country or after arriving?

Yes

What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

Application fee, FBI report, application printing costs, passport photos, doctor visit for medical clearance travel to and from embassy

Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

All covered by ALA, except travel to and from embassy

Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

No

If yes, please explain further

g) Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?

Begin as soon as possible and ask your org for support

What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure? How much did your vaccinations cost? Did you get a yellow fever vaccination?

N/A

How was your arrival and first week in your host country? Any improvements that could streamline the assimilation process for future Fellows?

It went well, only had issues with jet lag and a dramatic weather change.

Is housing provided by and/or paid for by your organization? Please explain.

Yes, ALA pays for my apartment, but I buy prepaid electricity from the grocery store.

Do you live in a location that is more urban or rural?

Somewhat Urban (Suburban)

Please describe your living environment

Apartment in a Golf Estate.

How do you typically travel between your home and your work? How much does your daily transportation cost and how long is your commute?

I usually uber for around 30 rand (one way) or carpool with my coworkers.

If you live in a more rural area, what are the closest urban areas you can travel to for shopping, airport, larger medical centers, etc.?

N/A

How is the weather in your host country? What season are you presently in?

It is not summer so it is hot with frequent storms .

What is the appropriate clothing for work and outside of work at your fellowship post and in your community in general?

Anything goes inside or outside of work. I usually dress smart casual or just casual to work.

How have you been spending your free time?

I have been going to the gym or boxing classes, hosting or attending dinner parties, and going out with friends.

I've been able to successfully navigate my personal/social life both back at home and at my fellowship post.

Agree

Please briefly explain your response below.

I have been able to build community here but have found it challenging to maintain relationships at home because of the time zone difference.

Would you say you live and work in a safe area?

Yes, both my job and neighborhood are secure.

What precautions do you take to ensure your safety?

I stay in safe or secure areas after dark and keep my belongings hidden when out,

What has been your experience with crime so far? (Please note that any security or safety concerns or incidents should be reported directly to PiAf staff per PiAf safety and security protocol.)

I have not experienced any crime.

Describe the incidence of crime and the general security situation within your city/town. Could you recommend specific areas future Fellows might consider for safe housing? What about areas that should be avoided?

Some areas of Johannesburg are more dangerous. I would recommend living in Sandton, Rosebank, or Roodepoort

Please refer back to the goals you set for yourself before orientation. Are you working towards these goals? Have you met any of them? Changed any of them? Please explain.

I am working towards my goal, particularly building my connection with the continent. Working at a Pan-African organization has helped tremendously.

Do you have any frustrations with your living arrangements, your work or your life outside of work?

No

Has there been anything that you have needed but have not been able to locate or acquire?

No

How have you dealt with "culture shock"?

I did not have culture shock.

What about your experience thus far has been the most...surprising?

South Africa's social dynamics and ethnic relations.

What about your experience thus far has been the most...challenging?

Feeling disconnected from my friends and family back home.

What are the top 3 things you miss the most from your home country or the U.S.?

1. Bojangles
2. My cat
3. My car/freedom to drive

What are the top 3 things about life in your host country that beat out life in your home country or the U.S.?

1. The music scene
2. My job (compared to my last job)
3. Diversity

How is your stipend being paid?

a) monthly b) US from PiAf and rand from ALA c) U.S. account

How are you receiving your stipend funds?

ACH

Did you raise funds to cover part of your fellowship expenses?

No

Please list any additional one-time or infrequent expenses not included in your monthly budget below.

Monthly Budget

Rent	Utilities	Furnishings	Phone	Home Security	Internet
\$0.00	\$50.00	\$0.00	\$25.00	\$0.00	\$0.00
Transportation	Fitness	Entertainment	Groceries	House Cleaning	Eating Out
\$40.00	\$15.00	\$50.00	\$132.00	\$0.00	\$60.00
Medications	Additional Health Insurance	Travel	Laundry	Other	Total Monthly Budget (Minus Entertainment & Travel)
\$0.00	\$0.00	\$200.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	0.00
Specify "Other"					

Final Thoughts

Please briefly explain your response about Orientation.

I think it had a lot of information that was useful but the virtual sessions made it hard to absorb it all.

Is there anything in particular that PiAf could cover at orientation that would have better prepared you for your fellowship post? Please specify.

No

Are you receiving sufficient support, materials and information from the Princeton in Africa office? What could we improve?

Yes, the handbook is the most useful resource.

As we plan the upcoming PiAf Retreat, we hope to incorporate some Fellow suggestions into our programming. What are some topics or sessions you would like to see at the Retreat? (We appreciate your feedback however, we may not be able to accommodate all suggestions or requests this year.)

Maybe some current events sessions and discussions among the fellows. So we can get a sense of what is happening across the continent and share our experiences first hand.